



PROPOSAL FOR A SEASONAL USE AGREEMENT

The Yawd at 63rd & Wabash

70 E. 63rd St. and 6255 S. Wabash Ave., Chicago. A proposal to bring a Caribbean music, culture and food venue to your corner for the 2027 season, at no operating cost to you.

PREPARED FOR

6255 Wabash LLC
Attn: Mohammed Abdallah, Manager
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PREPARED BY

Stephen Henry, Founder
Caribbean Cultural Center
Yawd LLC d/b/a Caribbean Cultural Center
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The request in one page

Your two parcels at the northeast corner of 63rd Street and Wabash Avenue (PINs 20-15-313-061 and 20-15-313-062) include a vacant corner lot. We propose to turn the corner into **The Yawd**, a Caribbean music, culture, food and community venue, for the 2027 outdoor season, under a written agreement you control.

What we ask: a seasonal license or short-term lease for permitted cultural and community programming during the 2027 season, with an option to renew each year.

What we offer: our labor and upkeep in place of a fee. We clean, maintain, secure and improve the site, carry the full cost of utilities, permits and insurance, and return it clean at the end of each season.

What the owner gets

- **Work done on your lot, in place of rent.** Clean-up, landscaping, snow and litter removal and security, at our expense.
- **An occupied, watched site** instead of a vacant one, which means less dumping, trespass, vandalism and code exposure.
- **No operating cost.** We pay for maintenance, security, waste removal, utilities we use, permits and insurance.
- **Liability protection.** You are named as additional insured on our policy, and we indemnify you for our use.
- **Full control.** One season at a time, with renewal only if you agree. The agreement gives us no ownership interest or purchase right.
- **A better-known corner.** A busy, cared-for venue raises the profile of the property and the 63rd Street corridor, and if you wish, you are recognized as the partner who made it possible.
- **Flexibility.** You keep access at all times, and an early-termination clause protects a sale or development of the property.

Why a Caribbean cultural center

Chicago has dedicated cultural buildings for dozens of communities, but in our survey of 66 enclaves and cultural centers we found none for the English-speaking Caribbean: Jamaican, Trinidadian, Guyanese, Barbadian, Bahamian, Belizean and others. Community leaders cited by the Encyclopedia of Chicago estimated 40,000 to 50,000 Jamaicans in the area alone. Those communities gather at festivals, but have no permanent home. This corner can be that home, one season at a time.

The next step

A 30-minute meeting and site walk with you or your representative. We will bring a draft agreement for your counsel to review.

A simple seasonal agreement, written to protect the owner

These terms are a starting point for discussion, not a binding offer. Final terms would be set out in a written agreement reviewed by both parties' counsel.

Parties	6255 Wabash LLC ("Owner") and Yawd LLC d/b/a Caribbean Cultural Center ("Licensee"), with Ras Tafari Inc., a 501(c)(3) public charity, as programming partner.
Premises	6255 S. Wabash Ave. (PIN 20-15-313-061) and 70 E. 63rd St. (PIN 20-15-313-062), Chicago, IL 60637. Outdoor areas first. The building at 70 E. 63rd St. would be used only after inspection, with the Owner's written approval and subject to any existing tenancies.
Nature of right	Seasonal license or short-term lease, at the Owner's choice. No ownership interest, purchase option or right of first refusal unless separately agreed in writing.
Term	About April 15 to September 30, 2027: setup, a public season from Memorial Day weekend through Labor Day, and teardown.
Renewal	Option to renew for each following season by mutual written agreement, on terms reviewed each year.
Early termination	If the Owner sells or begins development, 60 days' written notice ends the agreement (proposed; open to discussion). Licensee removes all of its property and leaves the site clean before the end date.
Consideration	No cash fee. In exchange for use of the premises, Licensee provides labor and upkeep at its own cost: clean-up and debris removal, landscaping, snow and litter removal on adjoining sidewalks, perimeter security and minor repairs, with a work log available to the Owner. Licensee also bears all costs of its use.
Permitted use	Cultural, educational and community programming: markets, classes, exhibits, fitness, youth and elder programs, and permitted public events. All public events held under the required City of Chicago permits and licenses.
Insurance	Commercial general liability of at least \$1,000,000 per occurrence and \$2,000,000 aggregate, with the Owner named as additional insured. Liquor liability if alcohol is ever served. Certificate delivered before any use.
Indemnity	Licensee indemnifies, defends and holds the Owner harmless from claims arising from Licensee's use of the premises.
Maintenance & security	Licensee keeps the site clean, secured and free of dumping and graffiti; handles snow and litter on adjoining sidewalks; and reports any damage promptly.
Alterations	Temporary, removable installations only (tents, staging, planters, fencing, signage). Nothing structural and no utility changes without the Owner's written approval and permits.
Owner access	Owner and its agents may enter at any time for inspection, showings, surveys and testing.
Neighbors	Published hours, sound limits measured at the property line, litter patrols and a resident contact line with logged responses.
Signage	Owner approves exterior signage. Owner's leasing or sale signage may stay up at no charge.
Restoration	At the end of each season, Licensee returns the site broom-clean and in at least the condition it was received.

The Yawd: a permanent identity with changeable programming

"Yawd" is Jamaican for yard, or home. The venue keeps one recognizable look (gateway, stage, market row and community row) while each day's or weekend's program changes the signage, food and music inside it. Every element is temporary and removable.

Gateway & box office. Entry, check-in, security and guest information.

Market row. Caribbean food, Ital and breakfast stalls, crafts and retail.

The commons. Open central floor for dancing, dining, classes and competitions.

Main stage. Live music, DJs, fitness classes, talks and film.

Community row. Culture House exhibits, Selecta Academy, wellness and play.

Dominoes & oldies yard. Elders' tables, tournaments and storytelling.

Concept renderings are available in the full-color edition of this proposal.

One venue, many celebrations

- SelassieFest; Jamaica 65 (Jamaican Independence, August 2027); Marcus Garvey Festival
- Country days: Belize Day; Trinidad & Tobago Independence Fest
- Food: Jerk Fest; Ackee 'n' R&B breakfast; weekly market
- Community: Gospel Sundays; domino tournaments; Lickle Pickney family days; ReggaeRobics fitness; Chicago House Music Takeover

A typical week

Mon	Dark day: maintenance, rehearsals, community production lab
Tue – Thu	Morning fitness and wellness; midday market and heritage exhibits; afternoon youth and elders programs; evening film, poetry or a resident band
Fri	Diaspora Friday: a country or city takeover
Sat	Full-site festival day (the celebrations above)
Sun	Gospel, brunch, family and oldies programming

Run safely, opened in stages, closed out cleanly

Safety and compliance

- City of Chicago special event, food vendor and amplified-sound permits for every public event
- Licensed security and a first-aid plan scaled to each event
- Clear, lit exits that no tent, queue or vendor may block
- Written weather rules: activity stops for lightning, high wind, extreme heat or poor air quality
- Health-department-compliant food service and handwashing stations
- Fire extinguishers at every cooking station; cooking kept to a separate service edge

Daily routine

- Pre-opening walk-through: site, exits, electrical, sanitation, accessibility
- Opening only after a signed readiness check
- Ongoing weather and crowd monitoring
- Post-close sweep of the site and adjoining sidewalks
- Overnight lock-up and incident log, available to the Owner on request

Good neighbor commitments

- Event dates and sound checks posted in advance
- Deliveries and teardown within approved hours
- A named contact for residents and businesses

Phasing

1. **Agree (fall–winter 2026).** Meet, walk the site, sign the agreement and deliver the insurance certificate.
2. **Prepare (winter–spring 2027).** Survey, code review and permit applications; site clean-up and perimeter security. No public use yet.
3. **Build out (from about April 15, 2027).** Temporary stage, market and community rows, fencing, planters and signage.
4. **Season (Memorial Day weekend through Labor Day 2027).** Soft opening with small, permitted programs, then the full calendar, coordinated with SelassieFest.
5. **Close and review (by September 30, 2027).** Tear down, return the site clean, and review the season together before deciding on renewal.

The people behind the proposal

Caribbean Cultural Center is being organized as Yawd LLC, doing business as Caribbean Cultural Center. Its mission is to give Chicago's Caribbean communities a cultural home built on unity, heritage and community.

Stephen Henry, founder, is President of **Ras Tafari Inc.**, a 501(c)(3) public charity and the producer of SelassieFest, a roots reggae and cultural festival. Ras Tafari Inc. would serve as the programming partner for nonprofit and community activities on the site.

More about us: selassiefest.com

7 · NEXT STEPS

What we propose happens next

1. A 30-minute meeting and site walk with the Owner or its representative.
2. We send a draft agreement based on these terms, for the Owner's counsel to revise.
3. Once signed and insured, we begin permits and site preparation, with no public use until permits are in place.

Contact: Stephen Henry · 414-909-3279 · stephen@selassiefest.com
765 E. 154th St., South Holland, IL 60473

Interest in proceeding (non-binding)

Signing below indicates only interest in discussing an agreement on the general lines of this proposal. It creates no obligation on either party; any agreement must be in a separate signed writing.

For 6255 Wabash LLC
Name / title / date

Stephen Henry, for Caribbean Cultural Center
Date